

The Partitive Plural — Monikon Partitiivi

Source: <https://uusikielemme.fi/finnish-grammar/finnish-cases/grammatical-cases/the-partitive-plural-monikon-partitiivi> — captured 2026-09-28

This article describes the usage and the formation of the partitive plural case, aka *monikon partitiivi*.

Nouns (e.g. *koulu*) can be inflected in the plural of each of the Finnish cases. We have the T-plural (*koulut*), plural *missä* (*kouluissa*), *mistä* (*kouluista*), *mihin* (*kouluihin*), plural genitive (*koulujen*), etc. Generally, the plural partitive will be the FIRST plural case you learn after the T-plural. Take these cases one at a time. They can be overwhelming!

Table of Contents

1. The Use of the Plural Partitive Case

1. Generally after the word *paljon*
2. To express indefinite amounts
3. To express indefinite amounts of time
4. To express the plural of numbers
5. For the complement (*predikatiivi*) of a plural subject
6. With negative sentences
7. With partitive verbs

2. The Formation of the Plural Partitive Case

1. Words ending in *-u/-y, -o/-ö*
2. Words ending in *-ä*
3. Words ending in *-a*
 1. Words of two syllables (*kissa*-words)
 2. Words of two syllables (*koira*-words)
4. Words ending in *-i*
 1. New words ending in *-i*
 2. Old words ending in *-i*
5. Words ending in an *-e*
6. Words ending in *-nen*
7. Words ending in two vowels
8. Words ending in diphthongs *-ie, -uo, -yö*
9. Longer words ending in two different vowels
10. Words ending in a consonant
 1. Words ending in *-s*
 2. Words ending in *-ton/tön*
 3. Words ending in *-tar/tär*
 4. Words ending in *-in*

11. The plural partitive of long words

3. Consonant Gradation in the Plural Partitive Case

1. Use of the Partitive Plural

1.1. Generally after the word “paljon”

The general rule goes that the [singular partitive](#) is used after “*monta*“, while the plural partitive is used after the word “*paljon*“. There isn’t always a big difference between those two, e.g. “*monta kirjaa*” and “*paljon kirjoja*” generally mean the same thing.

Finnish	English
Minulla on paljon hyviä ystäviä.	I have a lot of good friends.
Metsässä on paljon puita.	There are a lot of trees in the forest.
Maija on ostanut paljon vaatteita.	Maija has bought a lot of clothes.

There are certain exceptions to the “paljon + plural partitive” rule (e.g. *paljon rahaa*, *paljon rakkautta*), when the main word of the phrase is something [abstract or uncountable](#). In addition, *paljon* isn’t used for the subject of a sentence (e.g. ~~*Paljon ihmisiä myöhästyvät.*~~ > *Monet ihmiset myöhästyvät.*) Learn more about [paljon and monet](#).

1.2. To express indefinite amounts

If you want to express that there are many of something, but don’t want to get into the specifics of how many, you can use the partitive plural. You can do that in several sentence types.

- In the [existential sentence](#) “*Torilla on ihmisiä*“, the partitive expresses that there are multiple people, but doesn’t give any information about the quantity of said people.
- In [object sentences](#) like “*Ostan omenoita*“, the partitive plural expresses that you buy multiple apples without specifying the amount.

Finnish	English
Ostan perunoita.	I buy potatoes.
Metsässä on pieniä eläimiä.	There are small animals in the forest.
Syön mansikoita.	I eat strawberries.

1.3. To express indefinite amounts of time

Finnish	English
Hän on ollut Suomessa vuosia.	She’s been in Finland for years.

Hän oli sairaslomalla kuukausia.	He was on sickness leave for months.
Hän oli kadoksissa useita päiviä.	She was missing for several days.

1.4. To express the plural of numbers

Yes, numbers can also be inflected into the partitive plural! This is mostly the case for 10, 100, 1000 etc.

Finnish	English
Festareissa oli satoja naisia.	At the festival were hundreds of women.
Hän käveli kymmeniä kilometrejä.	She walked tens of kilometers.
Tokiossa asuu tuhansia ihmisiä.	Thousands of people live in Tokyo.

1.5. For the complement (predikatiivi) of a plural subject

You can read more about [the complement](#) elsewhere. Below you can find some examples of sentences with their complement in the plural partitive.

Finnish	English
Miehet ovat komeita.	The men are handsome.
Me olimme väsyneitä.	We were tired.
Mansikat olivat tuoreita.	The strawberries were fresh.
Ihmiset olivat hiljaisia kirkossa.	The people were quiet in church.

1.6. With negative sentences

Regular negative object sentences always have [their object](#) in [the partitive](#). That can be the partitive singular when we're dealing with a singular thing, or the partitive plural when there are multiple things.

Finnish	English
En osta uusia kenkiä.	I don't buy new shoes.
Me emme avaa ikkunoita talvella.	We don't open windows in winter.
Antti ei halunnut syödä lättyjä.	Antti didn't want to eat pancakes.
Ari ei ymmärrä ulkomaalaisia.	Ari doesn't understand foreigners.

1.7. With partitive verbs

Some verbs always require the object to appear in the partitive case. These are called “[partitive verbs](#)“. You will need to learn these by heart, because English doesn’t have anything comparable. You can use both the singular and the plural partitive with partitive verbs, depending on the amount of the object.

Verb	Singular	Plural
rakastaa	Minä rakastan suklaa ta .	Minä rakastan makeis ia .
odottaa	Sinä odotat buss ia .	Sinä odotat kavere ita .
pelata	Hän pelaa tenn istä .	Hän pelaa tietokonepele jä .
pelätä	Minä pelkään pimeä ä .	Me pelkäämme hevos ia .
opiskella	Te opiskelette suome a .	Te opiskelette reaaliaine ita .
auttaa	Me autamme hän tä .	Autamme kodittom ia ihmis iä .

2. The Formation of the Plural Partitive Case

In general, the plural marker is *-i-*. For the partitive plural, this ending can be *-ia/-iä*, *ita/-itä* or *-ja/-jä*. What follows is the plural partitive formation for short words. The partitive plural of long words will be addressed in [another article](#).

2.1. Words ending in *-u/-y*, *-o/-ö*: add *-ja/jä*

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
talo	talo ja	tyttö	tyttö jä
katu	katu ja	hylly	hylly jä
pallo	pallo ja	aamu	aamu ja
helppo	helppo ja	sato	sato ja

2.2. Words ending in *-ä*: replace the *-ä* with *-iä*

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
kynä	kyn iä	metsä	mets iä
isä	is iä	kesä	kes iä
leipä	leip iä	kylmä	kylm iä
pöytä	pöyt iä	ystävä	ystäv iä

2.3. Words ending in *-a*

I call the two groups of words ending in *-a* by the names “*kissa-words*” and “*koira-words*”. These two words are easy to remember and each belongs to a different group of words ending in *-a*. If you can remember “*kissa – kissoja*” and “*koira – koiria*” and apply that rule to other, similar words, you’re on your way to mastering the partitive plural!

2.3.1. Words of two syllables (*kissa-words*)

Kissa-words are words of two syllables. Their final letter is *-a*. In the first syllable, you will have either *-e-*, *-i-* or *-a-*. In other words, the vowels of these words can look like:

- a...a (*kana, maksa, sana, marja*)
- e...a (*herra, tela, teema, leija*)
- i...a (*kissa, tina, hinta, silta*)

When you inflect these words in the plural partitive, you will replace the final *-a* with *-oja*.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
sana	san oja	hinta	hint oja
kala	kal oja	kissa	kisso oja
teema	teem oja	marja	marj oja
kirja	kirj oja	herra	herro oja

2.3.2. Words of two syllables (*koira-words*)

Koira-words are also words of two syllables. Their final letter is also *-a*. They differ when it comes to the first syllable: for *koira-words* you will have either *-o-*, or *-u-* in the first syllable. In other words, the vowels of these words can look like:

- o...a (*koira, konna, honda, nokka*)
- u...a (*kukka, sukka, suora, juoma*)

For *koira-words*, you will replace the final *-a* with *-ia*.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
koira	koir ia	kukka	kukk ia
tukka	tukk ia	muna	mun ia
loma	lom ia	oja	oj ia

2.4. Words ending in *-i*

Finnish has many groups of words ending in *-i*. Not all of them behave same way when you inflect them. Please read this separate article on [old and new words ending in -i](#) if you’re not familiar with

this concept.

2.4.1. New words ending in -i: replace the -i with -eja/ejä

Please note that **not all new words** ending in -i belong to this category. This rule is specifically for **two syllable words** ending in -i. Longer words will not always follow this same rule. For example, *paperi* and *lääkäri* will become *papereita* and *lääkäreitä* ([see section 2.1.](#))

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
tiimi	tiimejä	pankki	pankkeja
posti	posteja	maali	maaleja
tili	tilejä	tyyli	tyylejä

2.4.2. Old words ending in -i: add -a/-ä to the basic form

All old words follow the same rule, regardless of any other factors.

For the singular partitive, you learned that there's separate rules for old words ending in -si, and old words ending in -li, -ni or -ri. Luckily, in the plural partitive, all these words are grouped together and simply get an -a/-ä added to their basic form.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
ovi (1)	ovia	meri (2)	meriä
kivi (1)	kiviä	sieni (2)	sieniä
sormi (1)	sormia	tuli (2)	tulia
järvi (1)	järviä	kieli (2)	kieliä
uusi (3)	uusia	vuosi (3)	vuosia
käsi (3)	käsiä	reisi (3)	reisiä

Find out more about the inflection of the [different types of words ending in -i](#)! This table contains three different types:

1. [Words that inflect like OVI](#)
2. [Words that inflect like PIENI](#)
3. [Words that inflect like UUSI](#)

2.5. Words ending in -e: add -ita/itä

The above “add -ita/itä” is a little inaccurate, but it's the easiest way to think of it. If you want to be technically correct, you should think of it as adding -ta/tä to the **strong** plural stem of the word.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
huone	huone ita	perhe	perhe itä
kappale	kappale ita	kirje	kirje itä
lentokone	lentokone ita	taide	taite ita
parve ke	parve kkeita	lahje	lah keita
tuote (pic)	tuotte ita	koe	ko keita

2.6. Words ending in *-nen*: replace the *-nen* with *-sia/-siä*

Again, this rule can also be rephrased by saying that you

1. add *-ia/iä* to the consonant stem of the word (e.g. *nais-*, *sinis-*, *ihmis-*) OR
2. add *-a/ä* to the plural stem for the word (*naisi-*, *sinisi-*, *ihmisi-*)

I think the concept of having all these different stems just makes things more complicated. We're here to learn how to use Finnish, not purely learn grammar. I think removing the *-nen* and adding *-sia* is much easier to remember.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
nai nen	nai sia	hevo nen	hevo sia
suomalai nen	suomalai sia	etei nen	etei siä
iloi nen	iloi sia	ihmi nen	ihmi siä
sin inen	sin isiä	tavalli nen	tavalli sia

2.7. Words ending in two vowels: remove the last vowel and add *-ita/-itä*

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
maa	mai ita	sää	säi itä
DVD	DVD:i itä	suu	sui ita
kuu	kui ita	harmaa	harmai ita
vapaa	vapai ita	jää	jäi itä
vihreä	vihrei itä	pimeä	pimei itä
korkea	korkei ita	leveä	levei itä

2.8. Words ending in diphthongs *-ie*, *-uo*, *-yö*: drop the first vowel + *ita/itä*

This rule only applies to words of one syllable. You will remove the first vowel of the diphthong, so for the word *työ*, you will remove the *-y-* and then add *-itä* to the end: *töitä*.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
tie	teitä	vyö	vöitä
suo	soita	yö	öitä

2.9. Longer words ending in two different vowels -io, -iö, -eo:

These words would actually belong on the page where I talk about the [plural partitive of long words](#), but some of these words are so common that they are usually taught at the same time as short words. For these, you just add *-ita* to the end of the word without making any changes to the word itself.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
televisio	televisioita	musео	musеоita
radio	radioita	stereo	stereoita
keittiö	keittiöitä	video	videoita

2.10. Words ending in a consonant

2.10.1. Words ending in -s

Please look at this overview of words ending in -s: [here](#).

1. Words ending in -us, -ys, -os, -ös: -ksia
2. Words ending in -is: -iita (small group, [section 1](#))
3. Words ending in -is: -iksia (more common, [section 2](#))
4. Words ending in -as: -aita (more [here](#))
5. Words ending in -as: -aksia (small group, [last section](#))

#	Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
1	keskus	keskuksia	kysymys	kysymyksiä
1	uutuus (pic)	uutuuksia	vastaus	vastauksia
2	kallis	kalliita	kaunis	kauniita
2	valmis	valmiita	ruumis	ruumiita
3	kasvis	kasviksia	kirppis	kirppiä
3	fiilis	fiiliksiä	julkkis	julkkiä
4	hammas	hampaaita	varas	varkaita
4	saapas	saappaaita	tehdas	tehtaita
5	ananas	ananaaksia	lihas	lihaksia

2.10.2. Words ending in *-ton/-tön*

Words ending in *-ton/-tön* will get *-ia* added to their stem, which ends in *-ttoma-* (e.g. rahattoman**n**, rahattomassa**ssa**, rahattomalle**lle**). Note that we use the strong form of the word.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
työ tön	työ ttömiä	kodi ton	kodi ttomia
rasva ton	rasva ttomia	järje tön	järje ttömiä

2.10.3. Words ending in *-tar*

Words ending in *-tar* have a stem that ends in *-ttare-* (e.g. *kuningatar* : *kuningattaren* : *kuningattarella*). In the plural partitive, you will get *-ttaria*. Note that these words get the strong grade.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
kuninga tar	kuninga ttaria	papi tar	papi ttaria
ystävä tär	ystävä ttäriä	kauno tar	kauno ttaria

2.10.4. Words ending in *-in*

Words ending in *-in* have a stem that ends in *-ime-* (e.g. *puhelin* : *puhelimessa* : *puhelimeen*). In the plural partitive, you will get *-imia*. Note that these words get the strong grade.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
puheli n	puheli imia	kahvinkei tin	kahvinkei ttimiä
puhalli n	puhalli imia	kiharr in	kiharti imia

2.10.5. Words ending in *-ut*

Words ending in *-ut* can belong to two groups. The smaller of the two are words such as *olut*, *kevyt* and *ohut*. In the plural partitive, these words will end in *-uita*.

The much larger group are [NUT-participles](#), such as *väsynyt*, *kuollut*, *mennyt* and *juossut*. These words will have *-eita* in the plural partitive. As you can see, the ending of both wordtypes ending in *-ut* is *-ita*, but the vowel right before the plural *-i-* is different.

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
olut	olu ita	väsynyt	väsyne itä
kevyt	kevy itä	tottunut	tottune itä

lyhyt	lyh y itä	kuollut	kuolle i ta
-------	------------------	---------	--------------------

2.11. The partitive plural of long words

Long words follow their own set of rules. Read more about [the plural partitive of long words!](#)

Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
mansikka	mansiko i ta	insinööri	insinööre jä
lääkäri	lääkäre i tä	asema	asem i a
ravintola	ravintolo i ta	ohjelma	ohjelm i a
palvelu	palvelu i ta	opettaja	opettaj i a

3. Consonant Gradation in the Plural Partitive

The partitive plural will always be **strong**, both for wordtype A and wordtype B. That's different than the partitive singular, where wordtype B words functioned with the weak grade.

Wordtype A			
Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
ty tt ö	ty tt öjä	pan k ki	pan k keja
puk u	puk u ja	pöy t ä	pöy t iä
hatt u	hatt u ja	kau p pa	kau p poja
silt a	silt a ja	kam p a	kam p oja

I have a separate article on [wordtype A](#).

Words with 3+ syllables (which end in -kko or -kka) are exceptions: they can have both a weak (e.g. *mansi**k**oita*, *tekni**k**oita*) and a strong (e.g. *mansi**k**koja*, *tekni**k**koja*) plural partitive form.

Wordtype B			
Word	PL Partitive	Word	PL Partitive
sav u ke	sav u keita	tavo i te	tavo i tteita
soit i n	soit i timia	op a s	op a paita
rak a s	rak a kaita	puhall i n	puhall i timia
keit i n	keit i timiä	ham a ss	ham a ppaita

I have a separate article on [wordtype B](#).

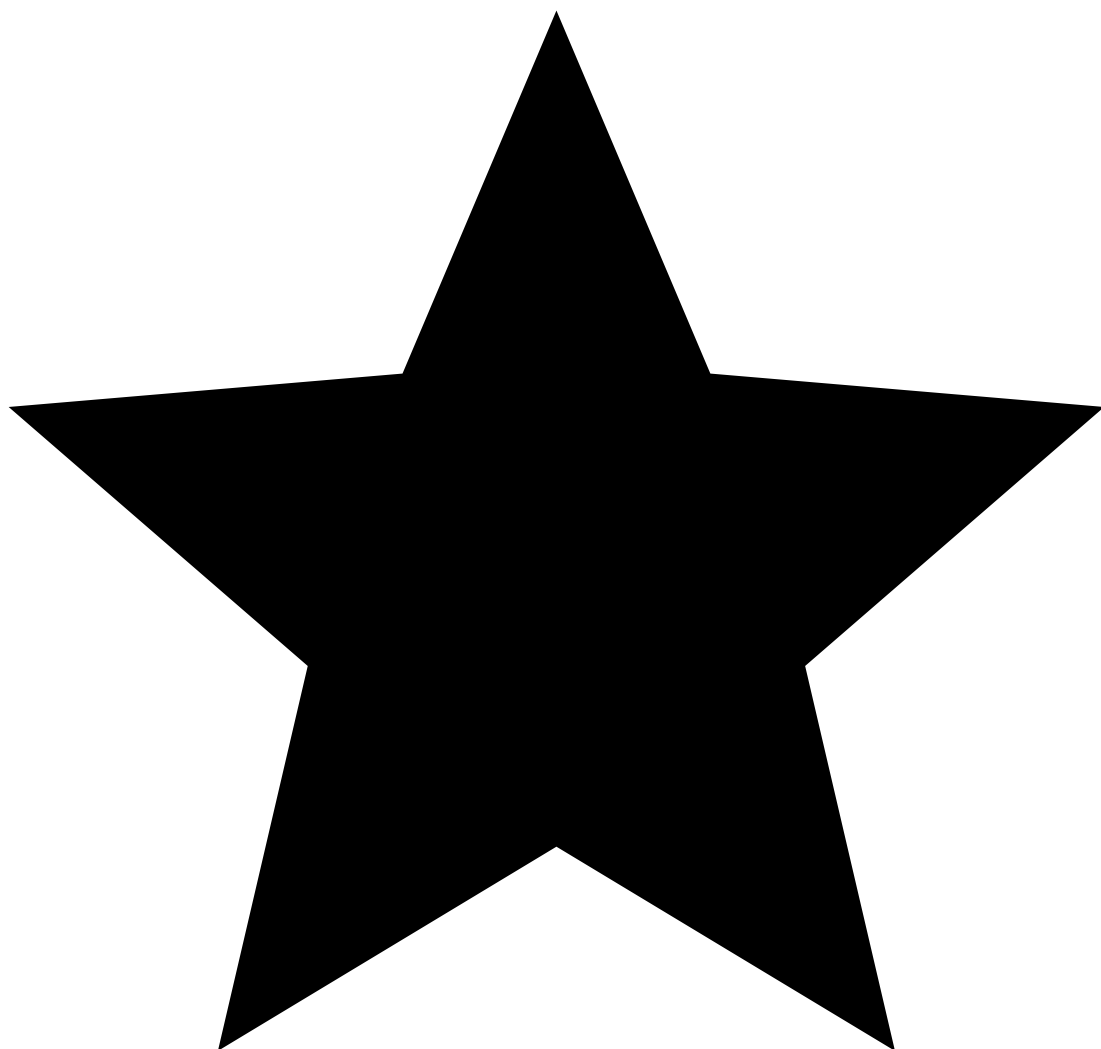
Related articles

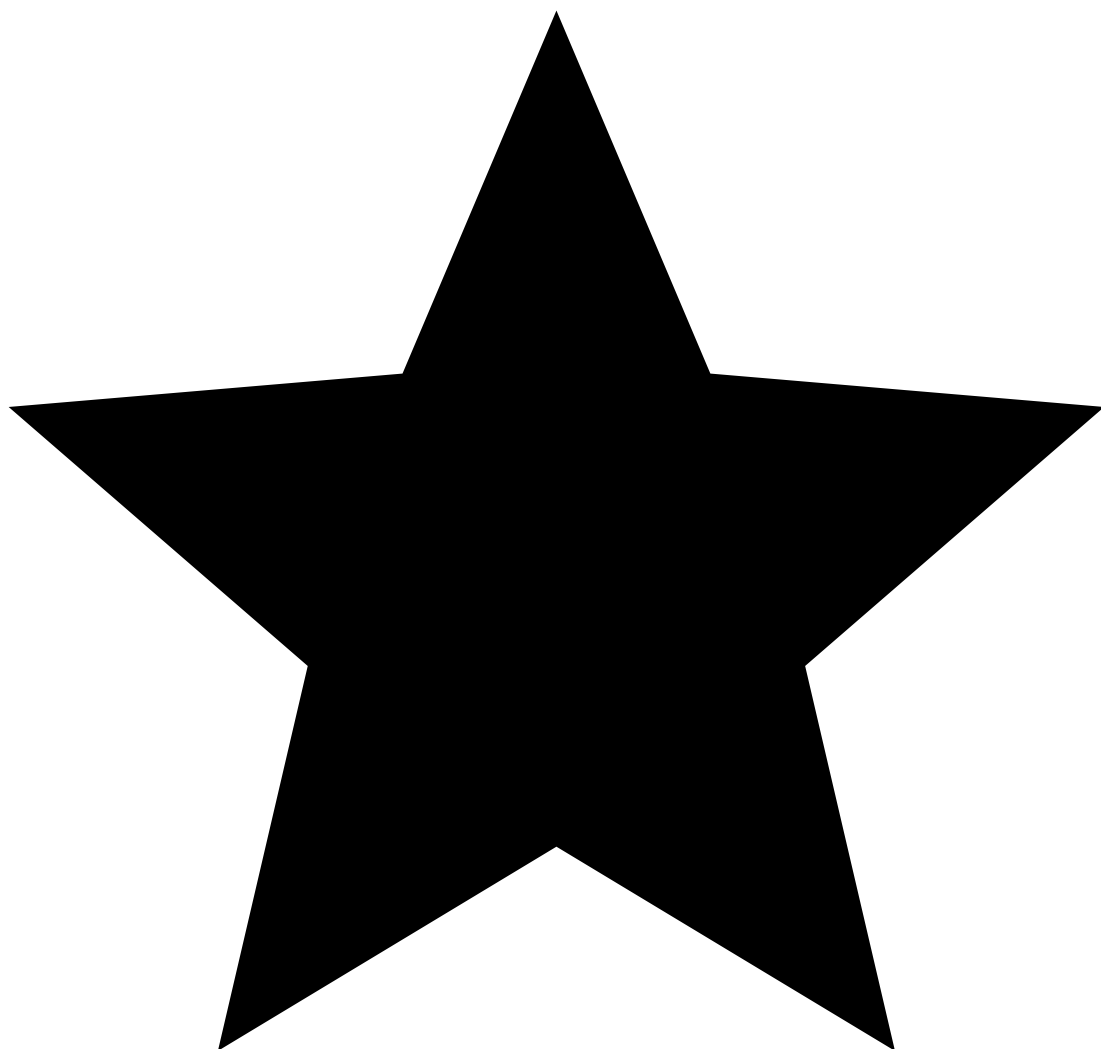
- [Long words have their own rules in the partitive plural.](#)
- [Learn when to use the T-plural.](#)
- [Check out this comparison of the T-plural and the plural partitive.](#)

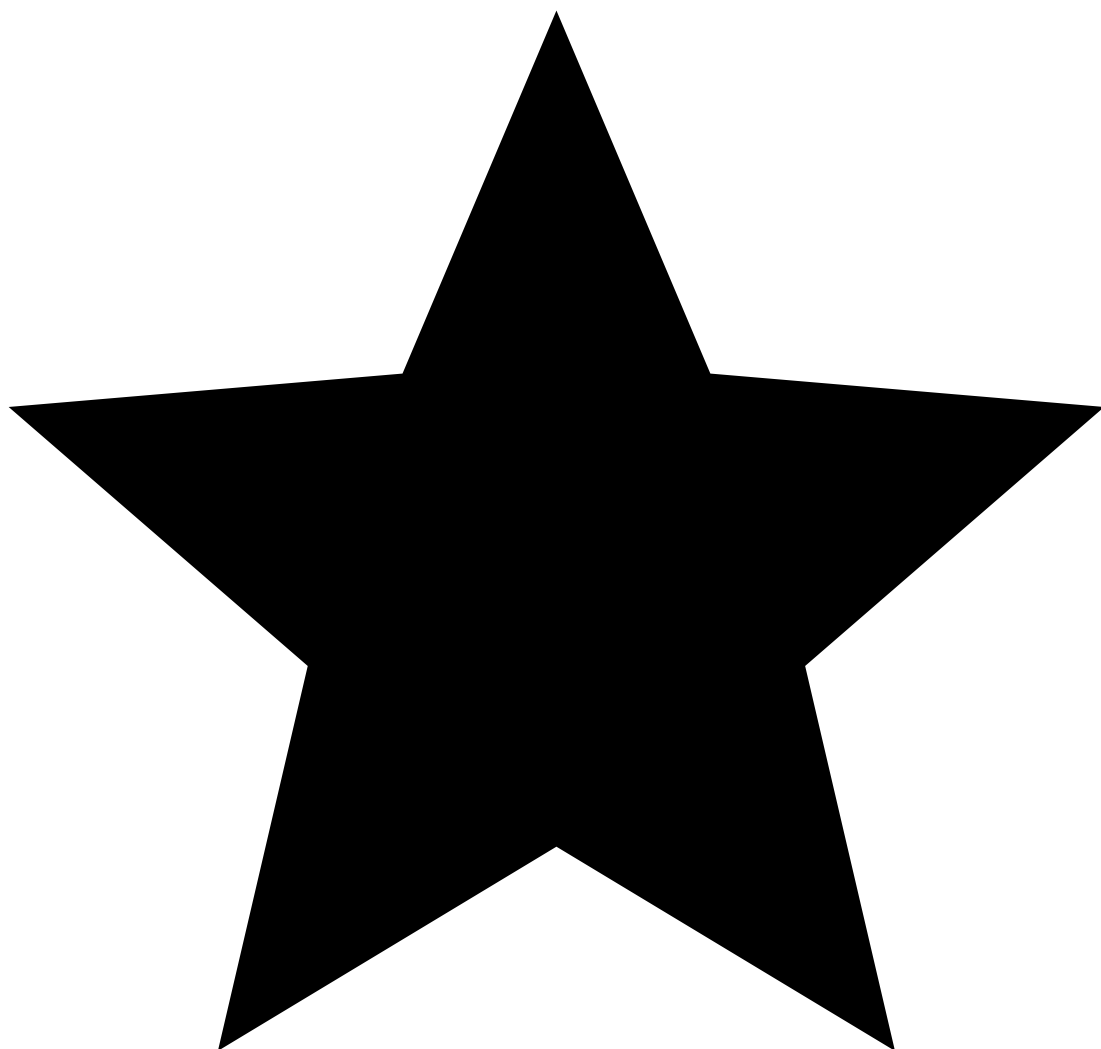
-  [Facebook](#)
-  [Twitter](#)
-  [Instagram](#)
-  [Discord](#)
-  [Email](#)

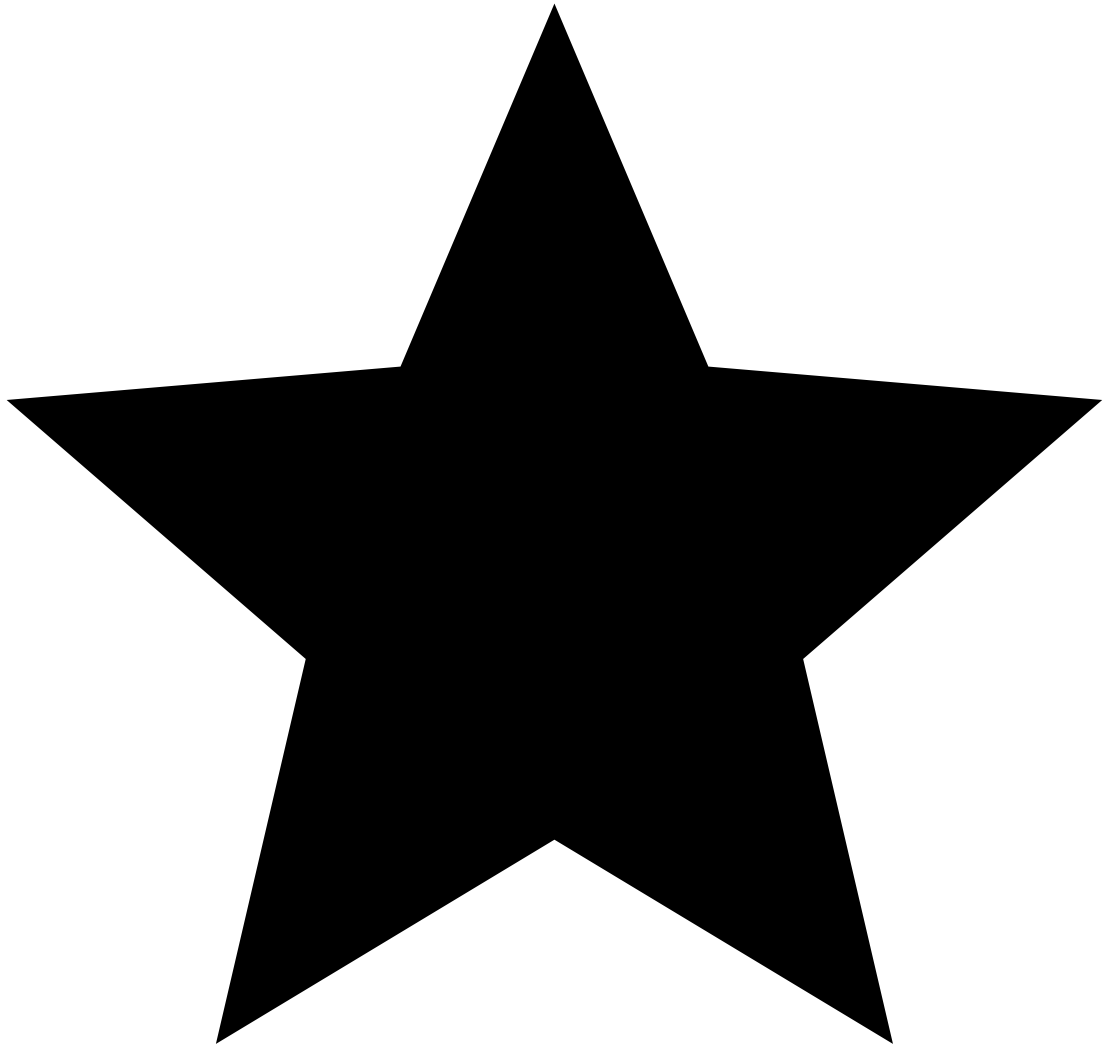
5 19 votes

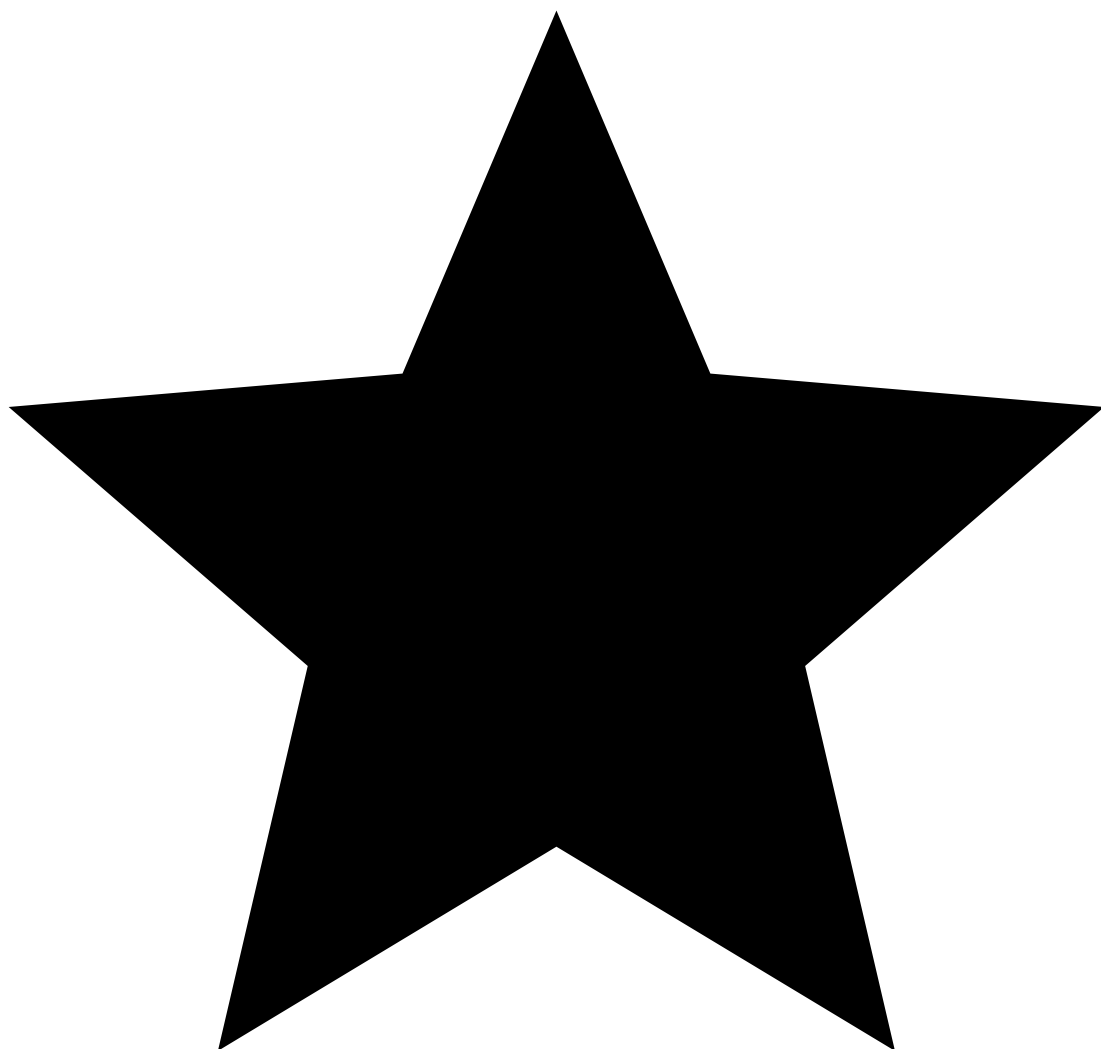
Article Rating

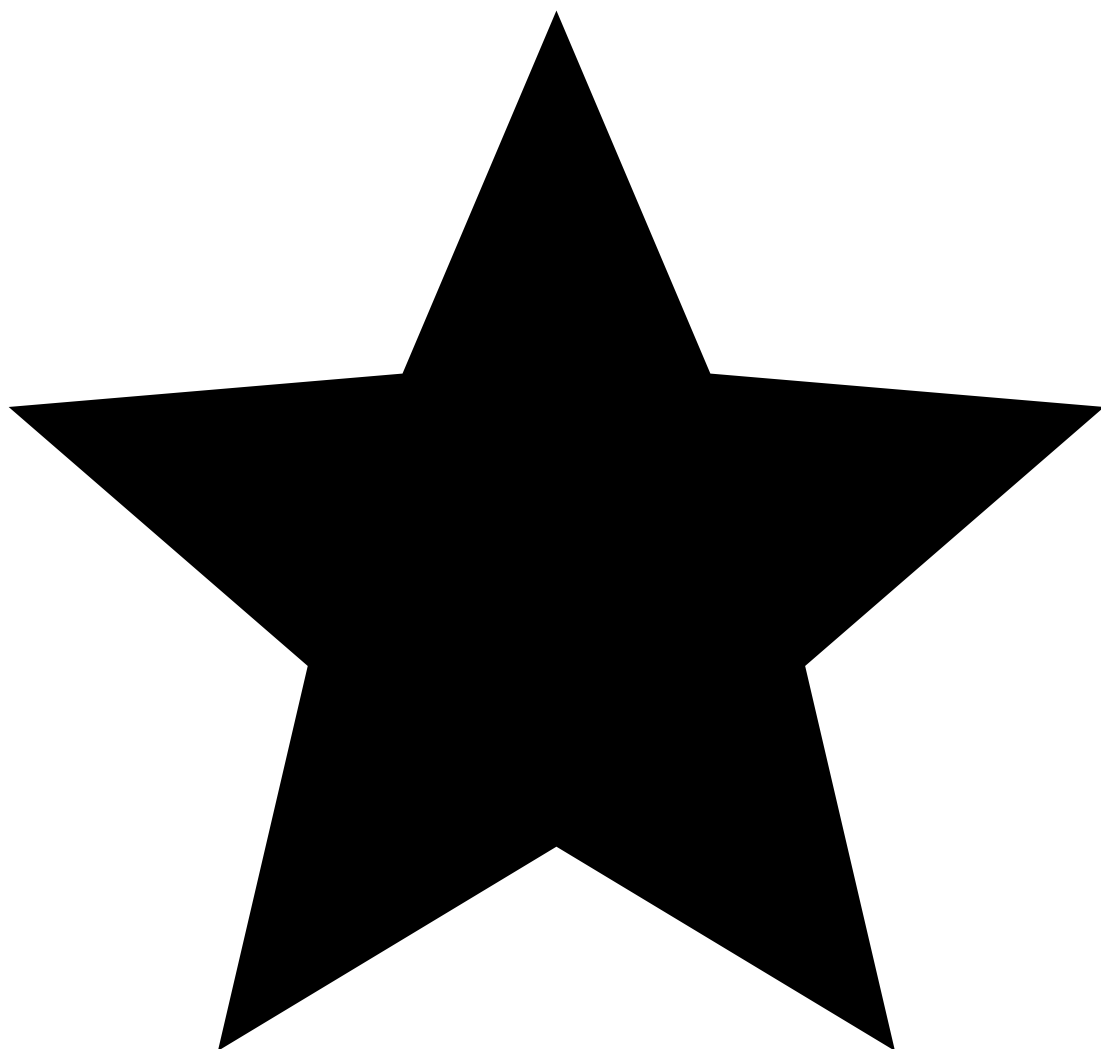


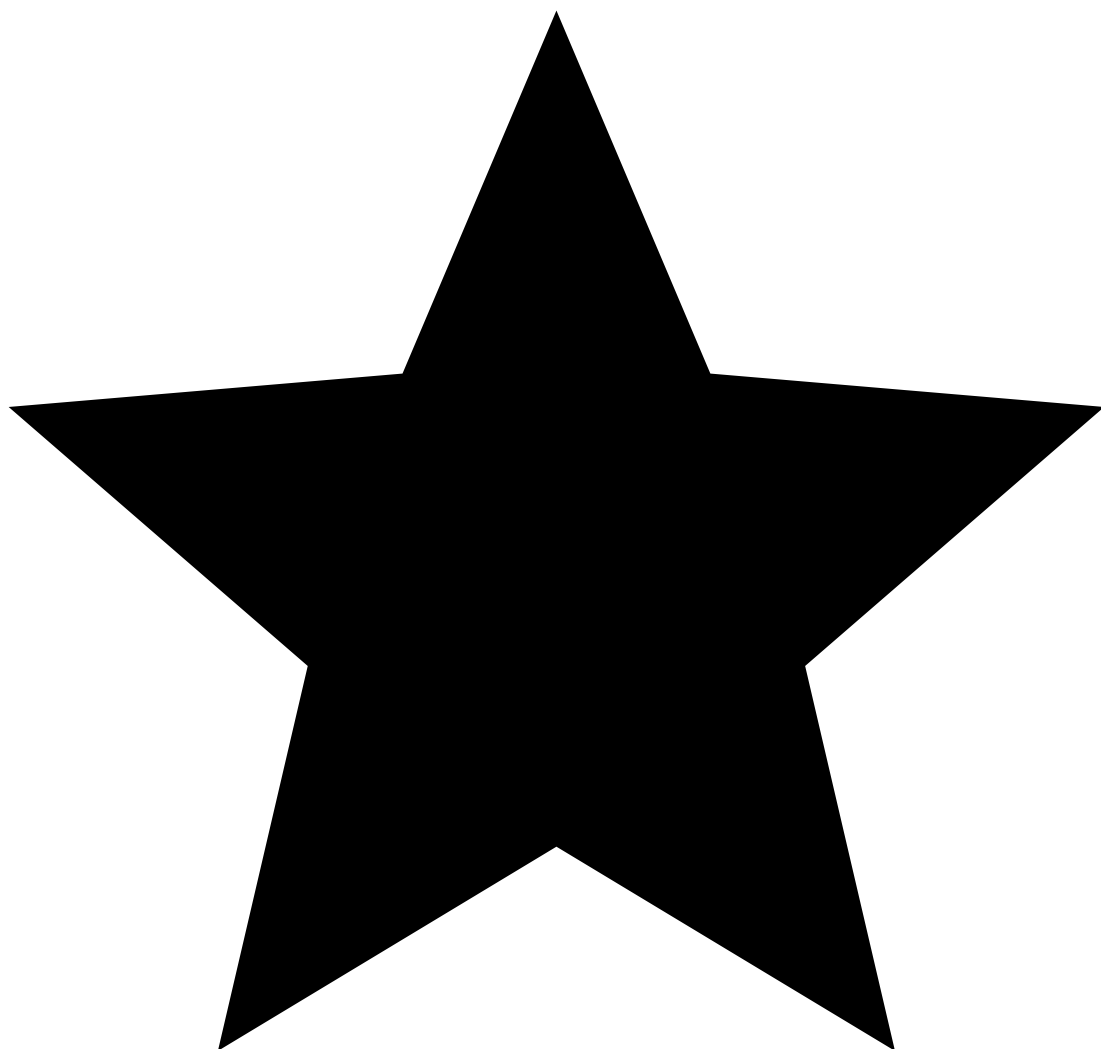


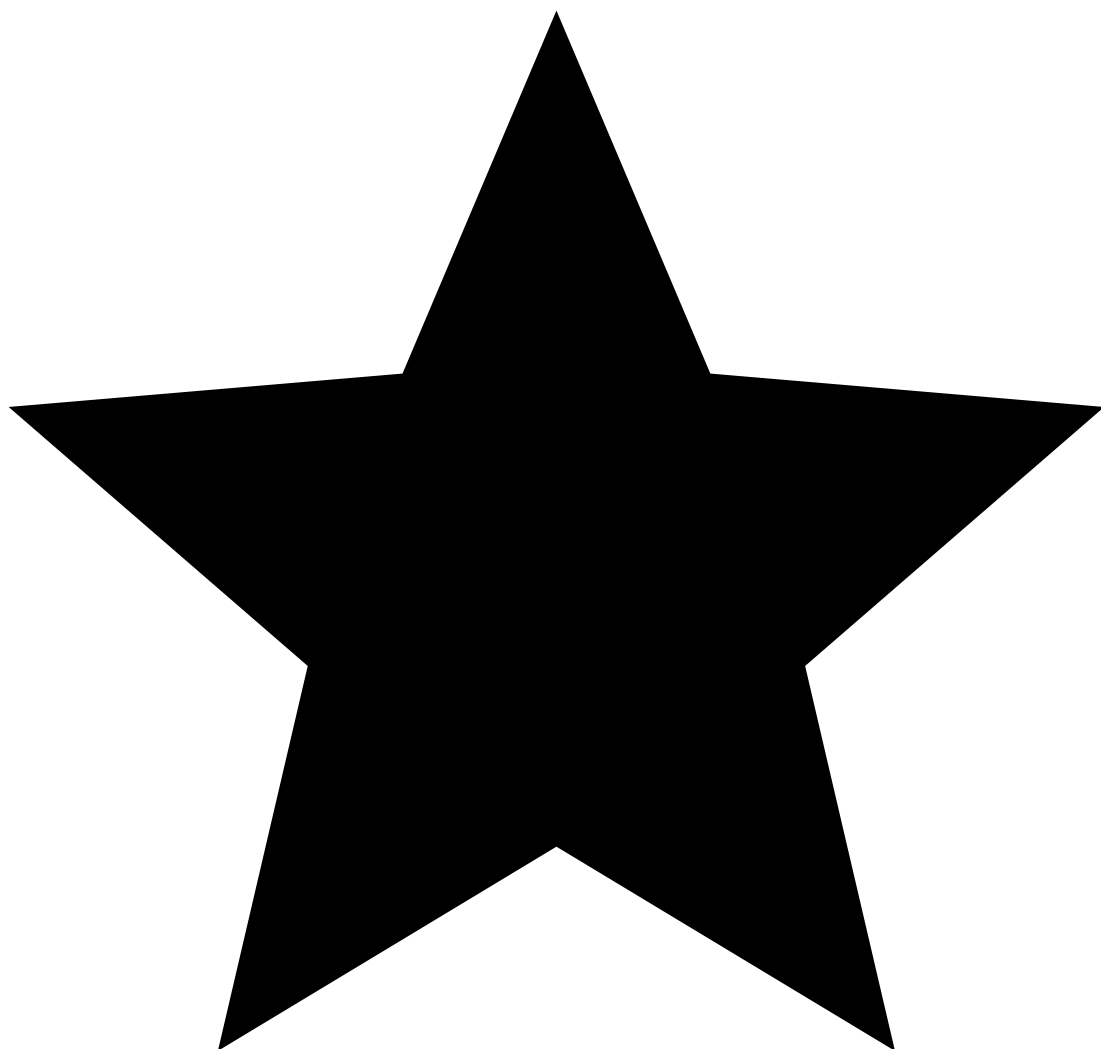


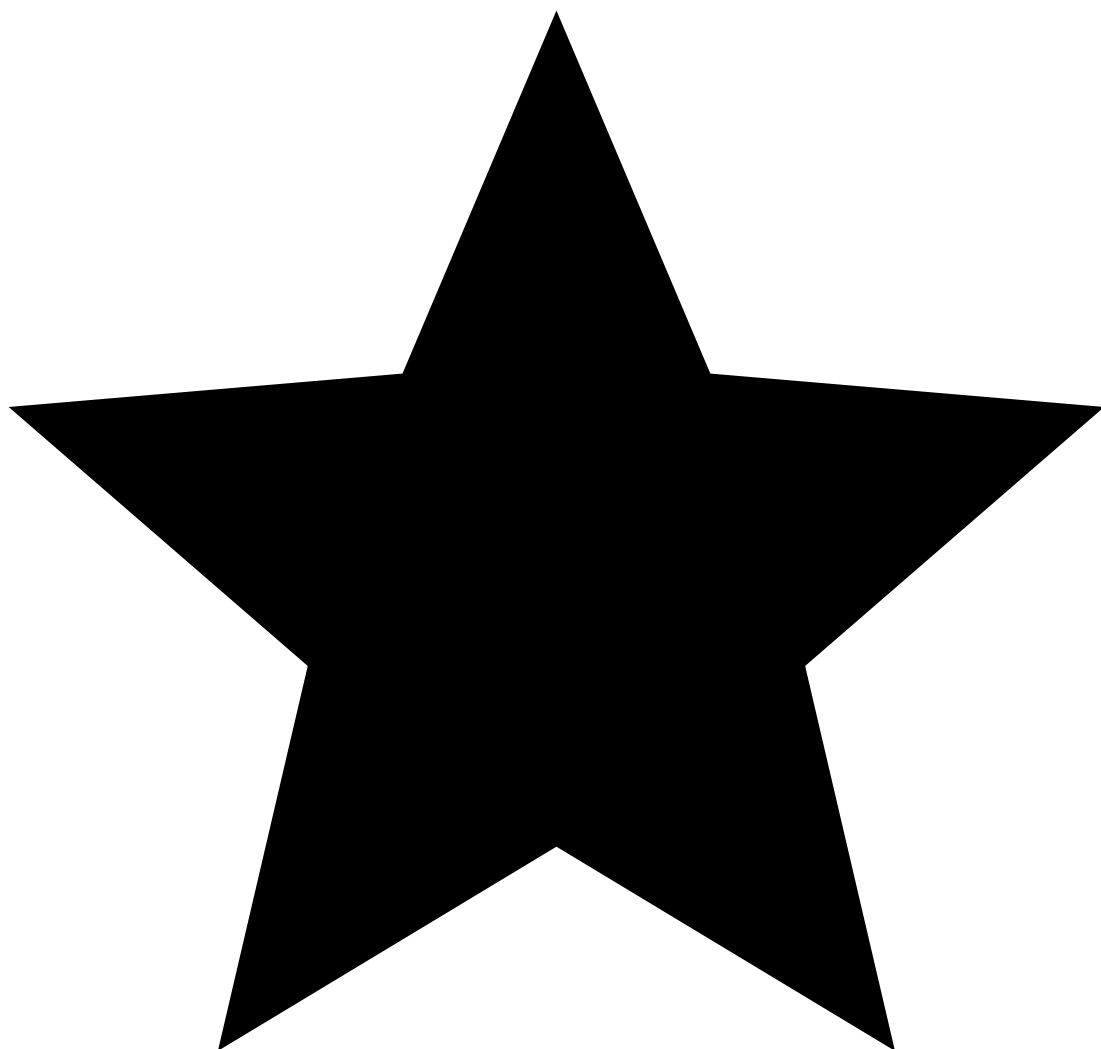


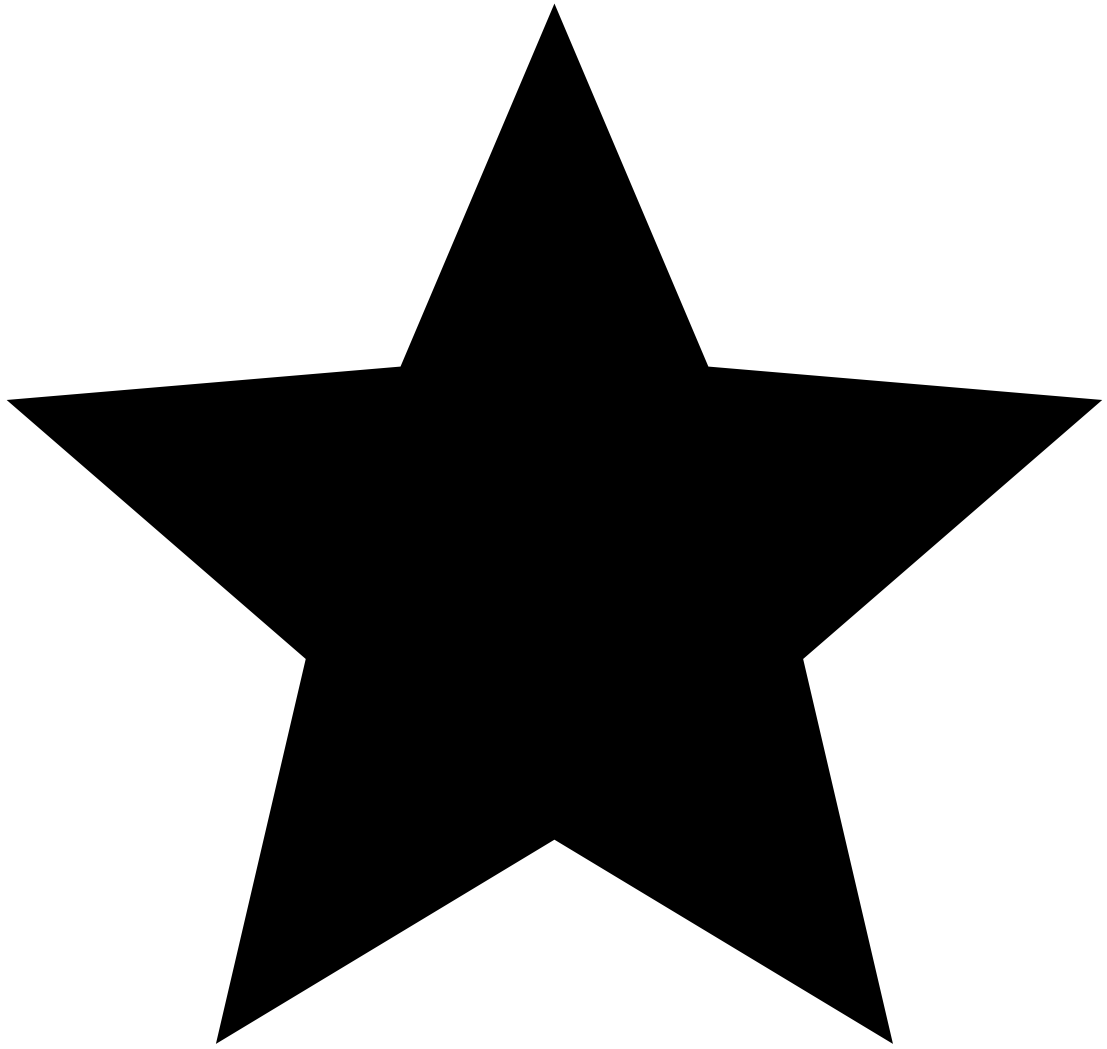












Related posts:



[Paljon Monet – Many People – Sentences](#)



[So-Called](#)



[Partitive Verbs – Not Always Partitive?](#)

[Koira-words in the plural partitive](#)



[Inflection of words like UUSI – Käsi vuosi kuukausi](#)